ENGLISH GUIDE

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 1

LP2: 40% OF GCSE ENGLISH LANGUAGE (1.45HR))

1 FICTION EXTRACT

TIME: 5 MINUTES

EXTRACT 1

Q1: COMPREHENSION - IDENTIFY... (2)

Q2: COMPREHENSION - GIVE TWO WAYS... (2)

TIME: 10 MINUTES

Q3: ANALYSE LANGUAGE AND STRUCTURE, 1-2 PARAGRPAHS, (6)

TIME: 25 MINUTES

Q4: EVALUATE, 3 PARAGRAPHS, 3 IDEAS, EVALUATIVE LANGUAGE EG. POWERFULLY (15)

TIME: 50 MINUTES

Q8 OR 9: CREATIVE WRITING, 3-4 PARAGRAPHS (40)

TOTAL = 64

TOTAL TIME: 1HR45MIN

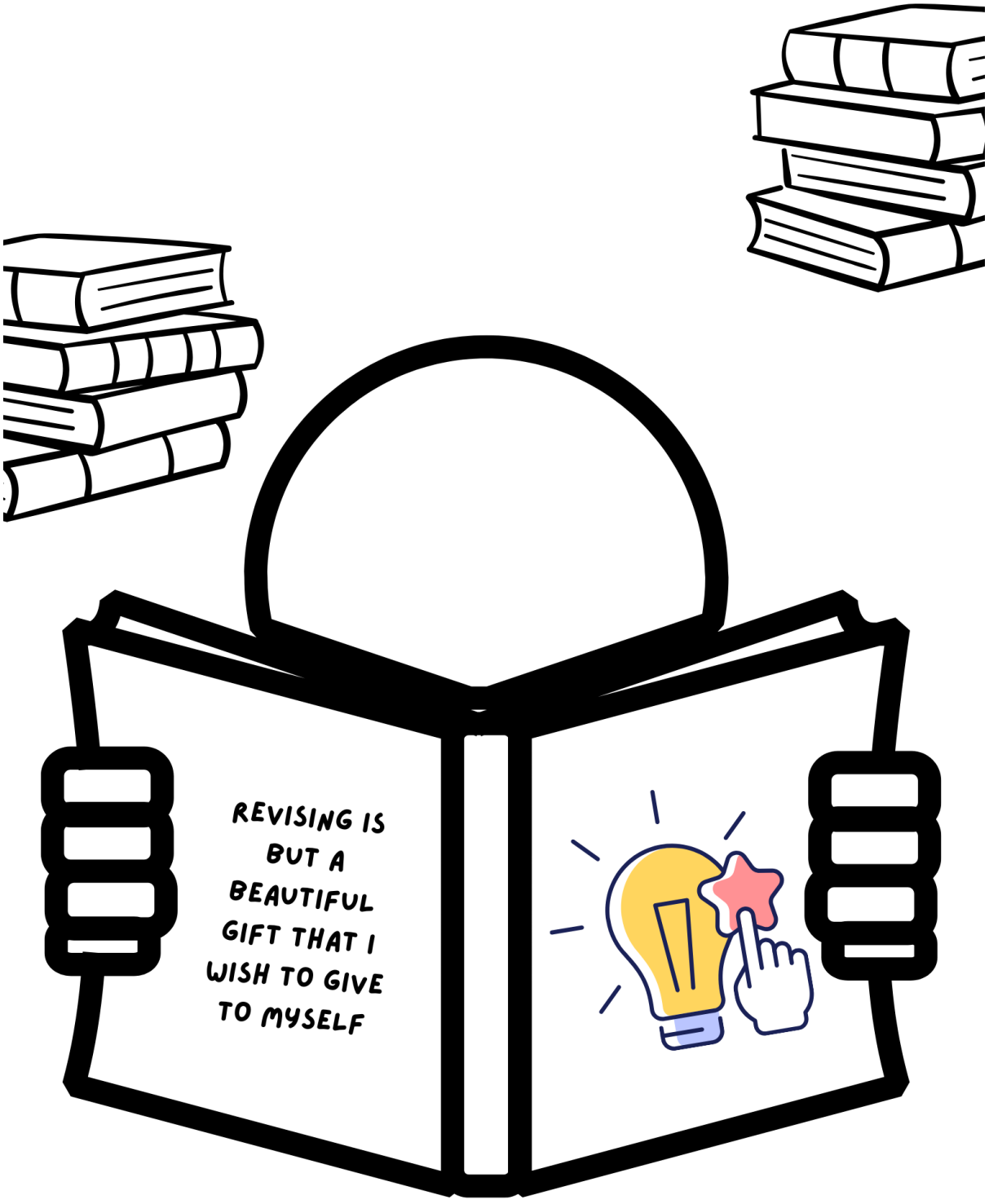

BE CREATIVE






BE CREATIVE

PART A: READING SECTION



DEVICES THAT CAN APPEAR IN THE EXTRACT

LANGUAGE DEVICES

PERSONAL PRONOUN: 'MY' - SHOWS OWNERSHIP

METAPHOR
COMPARING SOMETHING TO SOMETHING ELSE (WITHOUT LIKE/AS)

ADJECTIVE: A WORD THAT DESCRIBES A NOUN

PERSONIFICATION: GIVING SOMETHING THAT IS NOT HUMAN, HUMAN QUALITIES

STRUCTURE DEVICES

EXCLAMATORY SENTENCE: USES A '!', THEY ARE SHOWING STRONG EMOTION EG. FEAR, PASSION OR ANGER

LIST: A NUMBER OF CONNECTED ITEMS OR IDEAS ONE AFTER THE OTHER

RHETORICAL QUESTION: A QUESTION THAT DOES NOT NEED AN ANSWER

ANTITHESIS: OPPOSITE IDEAS



EXTRACT EXAMPLE

BIRDSONG
BY SEBASTIAN FAULKES

THE SECOND HAND OF HIS WATCH IN SLOW MOTION. TWENTY-NINE PAST. THE WHISTLE IN HIS MOUTH. HIS FOOT ON THE LADDER. HE SWALLOWED HARD AND BLEW.

HE CLAMBERED OUT AND LOOKED AROUND HIM. IT WAS FOR A MOMENT COMPLETELY QUIET AS THE BOMBARDMENT ENDED AND THE GERMAN GUNS ALSO STOPPED. SKYLARKS WHEELED AND SANG HIGH IN THE CLOUDLESS SKY. HE FELT ALONE, AS THOUGH HE HAD STUMBLED ON THIS FRESH WORLD AT THE INSTANT OF ITS CREATION.

THEN THE ARTILLERY BEGAN TO LAY DOWN THE FIRST BARRAGE AND THE GERMAN MACHINE GUNS RESUMED. TO HIS LEFT STEPHEN SAW MEN TRYING TO EMERGE FROM THE TRENCH BUT BEING SMASHED BY BULLETS BEFORE THEY COULD STAND. THE GAPS IN THE WIRE BECAME JAMMED WITH BODIES. BEHIND HIM THE MEN WERE COMING UP. HE SAW GRAY RUN ALONG THE TOP OF THE TRENCH, SHOUTING ENCOURAGEMENT.

HE WALKED HESITATINGLY FORWARD, HIS SKIN TENSED FOR THE FEELING OF METAL TEARING FLESH. HE TURNED HIS BODY SIDEWAYS, TENDERLY, TO PROTECT HIS EYES. HE WAS HUNCHED LIKE AN OLD WOMAN IN THE COCOON OF TEARING NOISE.

BYRNE WAS WALKING BESIDE HIM AT THE SLOW PACE REQUIRED BY THEIR ORDERS. STEPHEN GLANCED TO HIS RIGHT. HE COULD SEE A LONG, WAVERING LINE OF KHAKI, PRIMITIVE DOLLS PROGRESSING IN TENSE DELIBERATE STEPS, GOING DOWN WITH A SILENT FLAP OF ARMS, REPLACED, FALLING, CONTINUING AS THOUGH WALKING INTO A GALE. HE TRIED TO CATCH BYRNE'S EYE BUT FAILED. THE SOUND OF MACHINE GUNS WAS VARIED BY THE CRACK OF SNIPERS AND THE ROAR OF THE BARRAGE AHEAD OF THEM.

HE SAW HUNT FALL TO HIS RIGHT. STUDD BENT TO HELP HIM AND STEPHEN SAW HIS HEAD OPENING UP BRIGHT RED UNDER MACHINE GUN BULLETS AS HIS HELMET FELL AWAY.

HIS FEET PRESSED ONWARDS GINGERLY OVER THE BROKEN GROUND. AFTER TWENTY OR THIRTY YARDS THERE CAME A FEELING THAT HE WAS FLOATING ABOVE HIS BODY, THAT IT HAD TAKEN ON AN AUTOMATIC LIFE OF ITS OWN OVER WHICH HE HAD NO POWER. IT WAS AS THOUGH HE HAD BECOME DETACHED, IN A DREAM, FROM THE METAL AIR THROUGH WHICH HIS FLESH WAS WALKING. IN THIS TRANCE THERE WAS A KIND OF RELIEF, SOMETHING CLOSE TO HILARITY.

TEN YARDS AHEAD AND TO THE RIGHT WAS COLONEL BARCLAY. HE WAS CARRYING A SWORD. STEPHEN WENT DOWN.

SOME FORCE HAD BLOWN HIM. HE WAS IN A DIP IN THE GROUND WITH A BLEEDING MAN, SHIVERING. THE BARRAGE WAS TOO FAR AHEAD. NOW THE GERMAN GUNS WERE PLACING A CURTAIN OF THEIR OWN. SHRAPNEL WAS BLASTING ITS JAGGED CONES THROUGH ANY AIR SPACE NOT FILLED BY THE MACHINE GUNS. ALL THAT METAL WILL NOT FIND ROOM ENOUGH, STEPHEN THOUGHT. IT MUST CRASH AND STRIKE SPARKS ABOVE THEM. THE MAN WITH HIM WAS SCREAMING INAUDIBLY. STEPHEN WRAPPED HIS DRESSING ROUND THE MAN'S LEG, THEN LOOKED AT HIMSELF. THERE WAS NO WOUND. HE CRAWLED TO THE RIM OF THE SHELLHOLE. THERE WERE OTHERS AHEAD OF HIM. HE STOOD UP AND BEGAN TO WALK AGAIN. PERHAPS WITH THEM HE WOULD BE SAFER. HE FELT NOTHING AS HE CROSSED THE PITTED LAND ON WHICH HUMPS OF KHAKI LAY EVERY FEW YARDS.



Language Paper 1: Section A (Reading)
Extract-based Questions



ANALYSIS

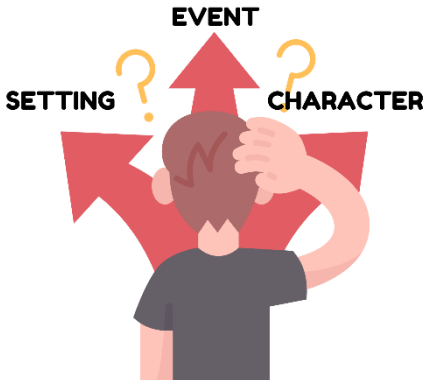
Developed explanation and analysis of language and structure devices
2-3 paragraphs, beginning middle and end
Include a reader's repsonse

SENTENCE STARTERS

The writer is... (link to question, what is the writer doing that answers the question?)
The writer says "..."
The use of _____ (insert device) implies...
The writer positions the reader to feel...

MODEL

The writer is creating suspense when they explores danger through the large amount of death within the extract, to imply something horrific must have occurred and is happening again. The writer describes the "coffins and corpses" that surrounds the characters. The alliteration of the 'c' sound is harsh and violent, portraying the violent deaths that have resulted in a large number of dead bodies. The noun 'coffins' suggests that these bodies will not receive a funeral or burial and instead will forever rest in the destroyed wasteland. The writer also conveys the danger through the antithesis of 'skylarks wheeled' and 'the roar of the barrage'. The contrast between a 'skylark' which is a bird that symbolises hope and the positive associations of singing is the opposite to the noise coming from the guns. This therefore implies that the danger is increasing, as the soldiers move from a place of peace and hopeful singing to a place filled with the sound of guns. The writer positions the reader to feel scared for the characters, due to the suspense created by the threat of death.



EVALUATE

Explore the setting, event and character
give a judgement on what the writer has done well
include a reader response

SENTENCE STARTERS

The writer successfully...
The writer effectively conveys...
This cleverly demonstrates...
The writer powerfully positions the reader to feel...

Model (setting):

The writer successfully creates suspense when describing the destroyed wasteland as unpredictable and dangerous. The writer effectively conveys the harrowing change from 'completely quiet', to the 'roar of the barrage' to demonstrate the sudden life threatening violence that occurs for the soldiers. This cleverly demonstrates an increasing desperation within the setting, amongst the 'humps of khaki' and wires 'jammed with bodies'. The vast array of dead bodies scattered throughout the setting within the extract subtly implies that a large number of people are suffering and dying. This escalating noise combined with the mass killings, cleverly insinuates the soldiers are in a deadly environment. The writer powerfully positions the reader to feel fear for the soldiers in the extract, as their lives are at risk. Therefore, suspense is created as the reader is forced to feel concerned about the possibility of yet more people dying, and the unpredictability of the brutality worsening.

PART B: WRITING SECTION



EXAMPLE QUESTIONS

WRITE ABOUT A TIME YOU FELT FEAR



WRITE ABOUT A TIME YOU LOST A POSSESSION



WRITE ABOUT A CHILDHOOD FRIENDSHIP



WRITE ABOUT A TIME YOU WENT ON A JOURNEY



WRITE ABOUT A TIME YOU HAD TO MAKE A DECISION



WRITE ABOUT A TIME YOU KEPT A SECRET



WRITE ABOUT A TIME WHEN THE WEATHER WAS MEMORABLE



WRITE ABOUT A TIME YOU CELEBRATIED SOMETHING



Language Paper 1: Section B (Writing)
Write about a time...



PARAGRAPH 1

Set the scene, using sensory language
Variety of sentence lengths
Variety of punctuation

SENTENCE STARTERS

- Thunder boomed over the...
- _____ hung in the air.

MODEL

Thunder boomed over the tall dismal building that towered over my limp body. Fear hung in the air like a neverending deathly fog. The ghastly stench of disgusting dirt clung to my nostrils, burning through any remaining hope. Anxious, I dug my hands deep into my pockets. Rain hammered down on hard concrete hell that spread for miles around me. A sharp pang of dread, fear and utter horror washed over me. My mind flooded with dark thoughts, struggling to expel what was bound to happen.

Paragraph 2

Could include a flashback
Explain how your got to your location, focusing on description
Continue using sensory language, punctuation and different sentence lengths

SENTENCE STARTERS

I cast my mind back to the moment when...
The sun smiled down on...
Why did... ?
I missed the...

Model:

I cast my mind back to my final moment of happiness. The only moment I have ever experienced true joy. The sun smiled down on the vast sea that roared in the distance. Why did I ever leave this heavenly place? I missed the soft sand under my feet, as my toes wriggled in the grainy coarse sand. The comforting feeling will forever haunt me.

Paragraph 3

Something dangerous or bad is happening, slowly build tension eg. someone is watching or approaching you
Use lots of short sentences, make sure you don't give too much away

SENTENCE STARTERS

Quickly, I turn my head..
A shadow is lurking...
The linger silhouette...

Model:

Quickly, I turn my head to stare into the dark abys behind me. A shadow lurked in the depths behind me, swarming in the darkness. My body shivered in the tendrils of the cool breeze wafting through the midnight air. The shadow came closer. Paralysed, I clenched my fists - digging my nails deep into my soft sweat palms. Slowly, the lingering silhouette came closer. Was this the end?

Creative writing: Model answer on ‘Write about a time you felt fear’



Thunder boomed over the tall, dismal building that towered over my limp body. Fear hung in the air like a never-ending, deathly fog. The ghastly stench of disgusting dirt clung to my nostrils, burning through any remaining hope. Anxious, I dug my hands deep into my pockets. Rain hammered down on the hard concrete hell that spread for miles around me. A sharp pang of dread, fear, and utter horror washed over me. My mind flooded with dark thoughts, struggling to expel what was bound to happen.

The building loomed above me, its jagged edges slicing into the stormy sky like cruel blades. Shadows danced across its grimy surface, illuminated by sporadic flashes of lightning that briefly revealed its decaying facade. Each drop of rain felt like needles against my skin, soaking through my clothes and chilling me to the bone. The ground beneath my feet glistened, a slick black mirror reflecting the chaos above. The air was heavy with the metallic tang of rainwater mixing with the acrid scent of decay. Shivers crawled up my spine like venomous snakes, spreading a cold that seemed to come from within. Every sound was amplified—the roar of the thunder, the relentless drumming of the rain, and the eerie creak of the wind slicing through empty spaces. The walls of the towering structure seemed alive, groaning under the weight of years of neglect, as if the building itself mourned its existence. My breath came in shallow gasps, each one echoing against the oppressive silence that lay beneath the storm’s fury. Somewhere in the distance, a low, guttural noise rumbled—a sound that didn’t belong to the storm, but to something far more sinister. My legs ached to move, but dread anchored me in place, paralyzing me in the grip of the nightmare that surrounded me.

I cast my mind back to my final moment of happiness. The only moment I have ever experienced true joy. The sun smiled down on the vast sea that roared in the distance. Why did I ever leave this heavenly place? I missed the soft sand under my feet, as my toes wriggled in the grainy coarse sand. The comforting feeling will forever haunt me. The breeze carried the salty aroma of the ocean, wrapping me in a sense of freedom I had never known before. The rhythmic crash of the waves was a lullaby, soothing every ache in my soul and silencing the chaos within me. The warm golden light kissed my skin, melting away my worries as if they had never existed. I remembered the way the sunlight sparkled on the water's surface, creating a dazzling tapestry of light that seemed to dance with joy. The laughter of distant voices blended with the symphony of nature, creating a harmony that felt like pure serenity. In that perfect moment, I felt weightless, untethered by the burdens of life—a feeling I feared I might never reclaim.

Quickly, I turn my head to stare into the dark abyss behind me. A shadow lurked in the depths behind me, swarming in the darkness. My body shivered in the tendrils of the cool breeze wafting through the midnight air. The shadow came closer. I froze. Paralysed, I clenched my fists—digging my nails deep into my soft, sweaty palms. Slowly, the lingering silhouette came closer. Was this the end? The air felt heavy. It pulsed with a sinister energy that made it hard to breathe. My ears strained for any sound, but all I could hear was the relentless pounding of my heartbeat. The darkness stretched endlessly, suffocating me with its oppressive weight, as if the night itself wanted to consume me. Each step the shadow took sent an icy tremor through my spine, its form shifting unnaturally, defying logic or shape. A cold sweat dripped down my temple, the salt stinging my eyes, but I dared not wipe it away. The faint rustle of movement in the distance grew louder, like claws dragging across stone, inching ever closer. My mind raced, conjuring grotesque images of what might be lurking in that shrouded void. My legs trembled. The shadow pressed against me now, suffocating and tangible, like a storm about to break—and still, I could do nothing but wait for whatever horror was about to unfold.

LANGUAGE PAPER 1

READING: 1 EXTRACT	WRITING: Choice of 2 questions
Q1 and Q2: Comprehension (4),	Q5 OR Q6: Write about a Time... (40)
Q3: Analyse (6),	
Q4: Evaluate (15)	

Devices for analysis

Language	What to say...
Metaphor	The metaphor compares _____ to _____ to suggest...
Simile	The simile compares _____ to _____ to demonstrate...
Personification	Personification is used to compare _____ to the human trait of _____, implying...
Adjective	The adjective '_____' connotes ____,____ and _____.
Structure	
Short sentence	The sentence is short, to withhold details from the reader / create a quick pace to...
Rhetorical question	The rhetorical question conveys confusion/ questioning about _____.
Exclamatory	The exclamatory sentence reflects strong emotions of
Long Sentence	The long sentence demonstrates how long/endless...

Analysis	Evaluate	Viewpoint	Explores	Connectives
Shows	Powerfully	Celebrates	Creates	Therefore
Suggests	Effectively	Promotes	Evokes	Hence
Implies	Creatively	Embraces	Establishes	Even though
Portrays	Cleverly	Questions	Reinforces	On the other hand
Conveys	Purposefully	Challenges	Develops	Furthermore
Connotes	Successfully	Rejects	Heightens	Thus
Emphasises	Subtly	Criticises	Conveys	Moreover

Key Vocabulary for Writing Section

Adjectives	Definition	Example
Ominous	Worrying that something bad could happen.	An ominous feeling unnerved me.
Thundering	Loud and powerful.	Thundering footsteps came closer.
Lumbering	Heavy and clumsy.	Lumbering creatures scurried around me,
Serene	Calm and peaceful.	Serene beauty overcame the land-
Poignant	Emotionally touching.	The poignant sadness washed over
Bewildered	Feeling confused.	Bewildered, I took a hesitant step
Verbs	**Definition**	**Example**
Articulate	To express clearly and effectively.	Articulating how I felt was difficult.
Captivate	To attract and hold attention.	The tall trees captivated my attention, as they waved to me.
Devour	To consume eagerly or destructively.	I devoured the delicious cake that he gave me, without saying thank you.
Illuminate	To light up or clarify.	Illuminating the sky, lightning struck.
Perplex	To confuse or puzzle deeply.	Perplexed, I wondered how someone could be so cruel.
Yearn	To long for intensely.	I yearned to find my way home.
Adverbs	**Definition**	**Example**
Briskly	Quickly and energetically.	Briskly, I made may way down the path.
Eerily	Strangely and unsettlingly.	Eerily, the wind howled.
Reluctantly	Hesitantly and unwillingly.	Reluctantly, I hurried past them.
Savagely	Fiercely and violently.	Savagely, he tore her apart.
Swiftly	Quickly and smoothly.	Swiftly, I turned to look for the noise.
Sluggishly	Lacking energy or speed	Sluggishly, I trudged towards a glimpse of light.